

Emergence of Bangladesh

North South University

Dhaka, Bangladesh

HIS 103

Welcome

Colonial Drug Trade in Bengal & South Asia

By

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- Poppy cultivation



1. **The Golden Triangle:**

Eastern part of Myanmar's Shan state, areas of northern Thailand and northern Laos, bordering southwest China

2. **The Golden Crescent:** consists of northeastern and southern Afghanistan, NWFP of Pakistan and Shistan Baluchistan of Iran.

3. **The Golden Wedge** :consists of northern India (Himachal Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh & Arunachal Pradesh), parts of Nepal and Bhutan



- Channel I *Tritio Matra* -Interview of NSU professor M. Emdadul Haq:

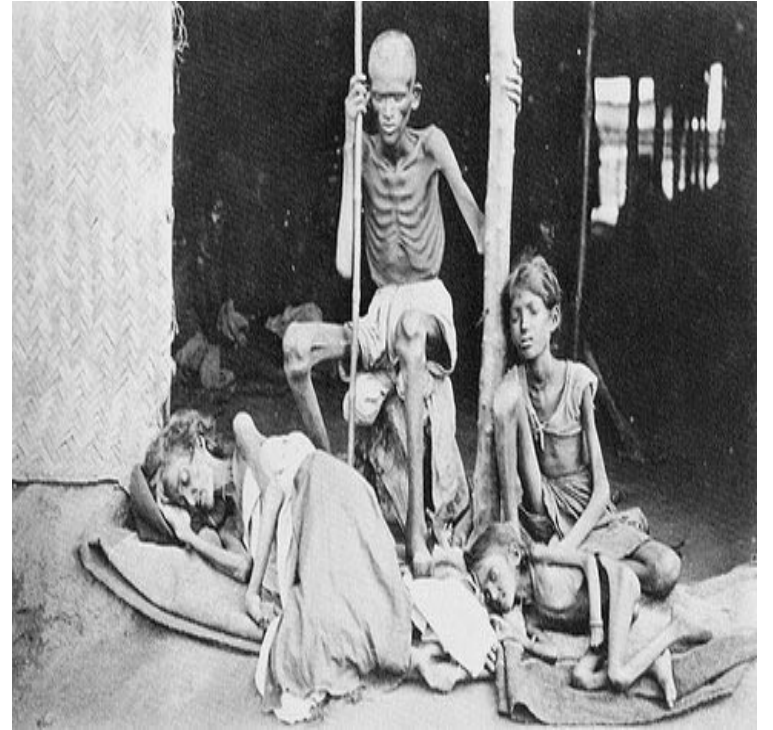
<https://m.youtube.com/watch?v=qJrY0YpcPTE>

- Poppy has been extensively cultivated in the mountainous areas of Myanmar, Laos, Southern China, and Vietnam since the nineteenth century. By the late 1980s and early 1990s, **Southeast Asia** had become one of the most significant opium and **heroin producing** and trafficking regions in the world.
- Six countries—Cambodia, China, Laos, Myanmar, Thailand, and Vietnam—are part of a geographical region known as the *Greater Mekong Sub-region (GMS)*, approximately 12,000 km², which is acknowledged as one of the **world's major locations for production of illicit drugs**, including heroin and ATS.
- Drug trade for profit-making

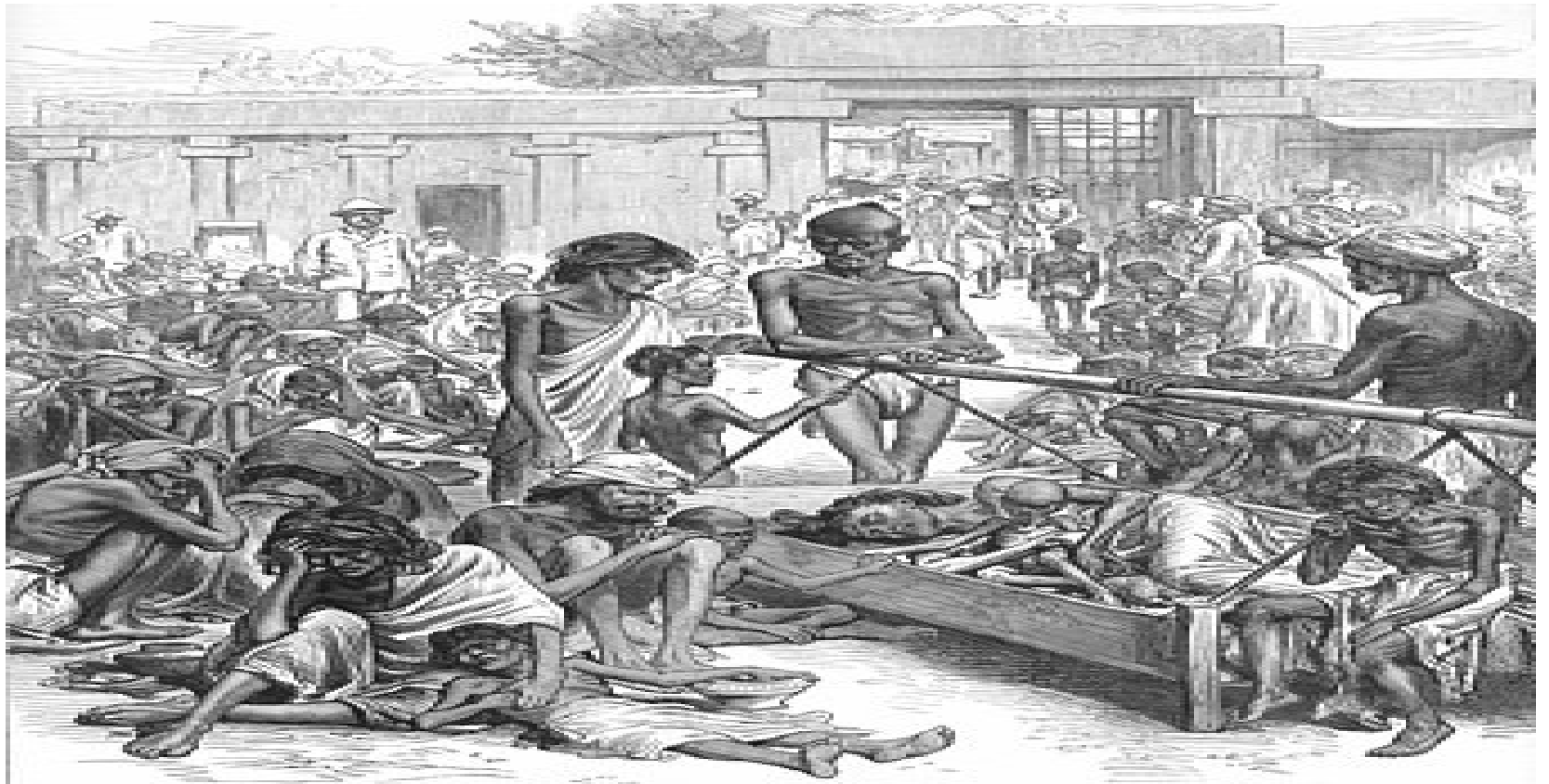
1. Through the dealings of the British East India Company, opium, traditionally used medicinally, became **a non-medicinal business commodity** during the late eighteenth and throughout the nineteenth centuries.

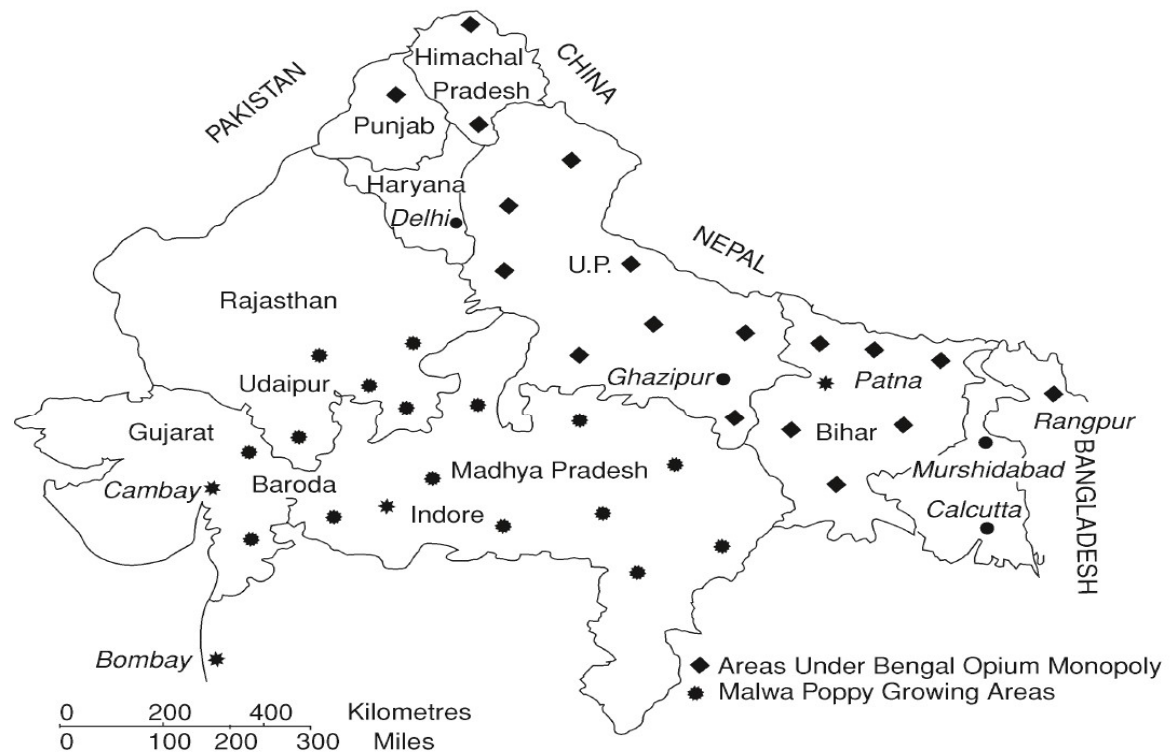
2. For capital formation, as well as to run the administration, the colonial government in India continued the supply of opium to **China** throughout the nineteenth century.

- The land under poppy cultivation was increased from 283,000 hectares in 1765-6, to 303,500 hectares in the following year.
- This large-scale conversion of paddy fields into poppy cultivation contributed to a famine in Bengal in 1770.
- This famine caused the death of 10 million in an area that had been traditionally known as the 'Golden Bengal' due to its natural resources.



People in the famine stricken Bengal in 1770 after their paddy fields were converted by the BEIC for poppy cultivation





Map 1 India: traditional poppy growing areas (1997 boundary)

The process of monopoly opium in colonial India



Table 1.1 *Bengal government opium monopoly, 1844–55*

<i>Year</i>	<i>Total exports (in metric tons)</i>	<i>Total receipts (in million Rs)</i>
1845–6	1572	26.68
1846–7	1577	27.80
1847–8	2230	27.26
1848–9	2612	35.47
1849–50	2500	35.72
1850–1	2334	32.62
1851–2	2213	37.74
1852–3	2557	38.73
1853–4	3144	37.22
1854–5	3241	37.11

Source: ‘Returns Relating to the Growth, &c; of Opium’, British Parliamentary Papers, *East India (Opium)*, 1857, Session 1 (60), volume 11, p. 124.

- Under the **Opium Act of 1857**, the cultivation of poppy and manufacture of opium went under **the direct control** of the Bengal administration and the Board of Revenue at Calcutta.
- Subsequent to the **initial battles for Opium**, Bengal became springboard for **British colonial expansion** in different directions.
- After the Boxer war **in 1864**, the BEIC **annexed areas one after another** which became strategically important to them to maintain their supremacy in the **regional opium traffic**.

- As a result of the US's *Cold War* in Afghanistan, combined with the Pakistani perception of a threat to its territorial integrity in NWFP and Baluchistan, the *Pathan* cultivators produced record-breaking illicit opium in 1979.
- The tunneling of *drug money into the politics of insurgency* has to institutionalize the drug trade in Pakistan.

- The relationship between demand and supply is not entirely linear, but demand for heroin may be linked in part to the resurgence of opium production.
- Among people using heroin, those who **inject drugs** are one of the **most vulnerable and marginalized groups**, a substantial cause of disease **burden**, and a contributor to blood-borne virus transmission

- **Narcotics trafficking** is more than transnational, it is global. Trafficking in opium, cannabis, and cocaine has been **shifting and diversifying**, and to these have been added **amphetamine-type stimulants** (ATS) and new psychotropic substances (NPS).
- Statistics show that approximately 10.6 million people injected drugs worldwide in 2016, or 0.22% of the global population aged **15–64**.
- Around 7.5 million people addicted to drugs in Bangladesh.
- Around 43% of the unemployed population of the country are addicted to drugs.

- Indian official reports claimed that the obstacles in the Iranian and Central Asian routes in the early 1980s saw Pakistani traffickers increasingly use India as a transit route for overseas destinations.
- Bangladesh is used a transit route for illicit drug trafficking
- Drug gangs use *Rohingya* to get the *Yaba* into southern Bangladesh
- The rise of organized drug cartels in Bangladesh. It has larger security and geopolitical implications
- Drug money is used for running insurgent movements in the Chittagong Hill Tracts (CHT) as the region has geo-strategic importance.

- The increasing demand for yaba has been a **matter of grave concerns** to the social scientists and policy makers of Bangladesh. In 2018, Bangladeshi authorities seized **53 million yaba** tablets nationally. The total value of this illicit business is estimated to be worth upwards of **\$1bn a year**
- **Some fishermen, farmers and traders in Cox's Bazar and Teknaf were consequently drawn into a corrupt network of yaba smuggling, involving also Rohingyas (Hasan, 2019).**



- According to a report, at least 15 influential persons of Rajshahi are engaged in trading and smuggling drugs into the country, says a home ministry report (Source: <https://en.prothomalo.com/bangladesh/AL-MP-patronising-drug-trade>).

- The government of Bangladesh has adopted a zero-tolerance policy towards drug use, which law enforcement agencies have striven to reinforce.
- Bangladeshi Narcotics Control Act of 2018 mandated the death sentence or life imprisonment for individuals carrying methamphetamine for illicit use (S. I. Khan et al., 2019).
- In May 2018, Bangladesh Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina announced a drug war, leading to over 300 killings and 25,000 arrests. In justifying her campaign, Hasina spoke of drugs as a “deadly disease” alongside corruption and militancy (Lascoa, 2020).

সীমান্তের অতন্দ্র প্রহরী বর্ডার গার্ড বাংলাদেশ এর সদস্যরা ০১ এপ্রিল ২০১৯ থেকে ৩০ জুন ২০১৯ তারিখ পর্যন্ত চোরাচালান বিরোধী অভিযান চালিয়ে বিভিন্ন সীমান্তে উল্লেখযোগ্য পরিমাণ মালামালসহ ৬৭৭ জন চোরাকারবারীকে আটক করে। এ ব্যাপারে মোট ৬১৫৮ টি মামলা দায়ের করা হয়েছে। বিভিন্ন রিজিয়নে আটককৃত মালামালের মূল্য নিম্নে প্রদত্ত হলো:

রিজিয়নের নাম	মামলার সংখ্যা	আটককৃত চোরাকারবারীর সংখ্যা	আটককৃত মালামালের মূল্য
দক্ষিণ-পশ্চিম রিজিয়ন, যশোর	১৭৭৫	১৮২	৪৫,৪৭,৮৮,০১০/-
উত্তর-পশ্চিম রিজিয়ন, রংপুর	১৯৩০	১৪০	২১,২১,৮৬,৪৭০/-
উত্তর-পূর্ব রিজিয়ন, সরাইল	২০৬৫	২২৩	৪১,৮৫,৩১,৭৫৭/-
দক্ষিণ-পূর্ব রিজিয়ন, চট্টগ্রাম	৯৮	২৫	৫,৯৭,৮৯,৭৫১/-
কক্সবাজার রিজিয়ন	২৯০	১০৭	৯৮,৮৬,৪৩,৮২৩/-
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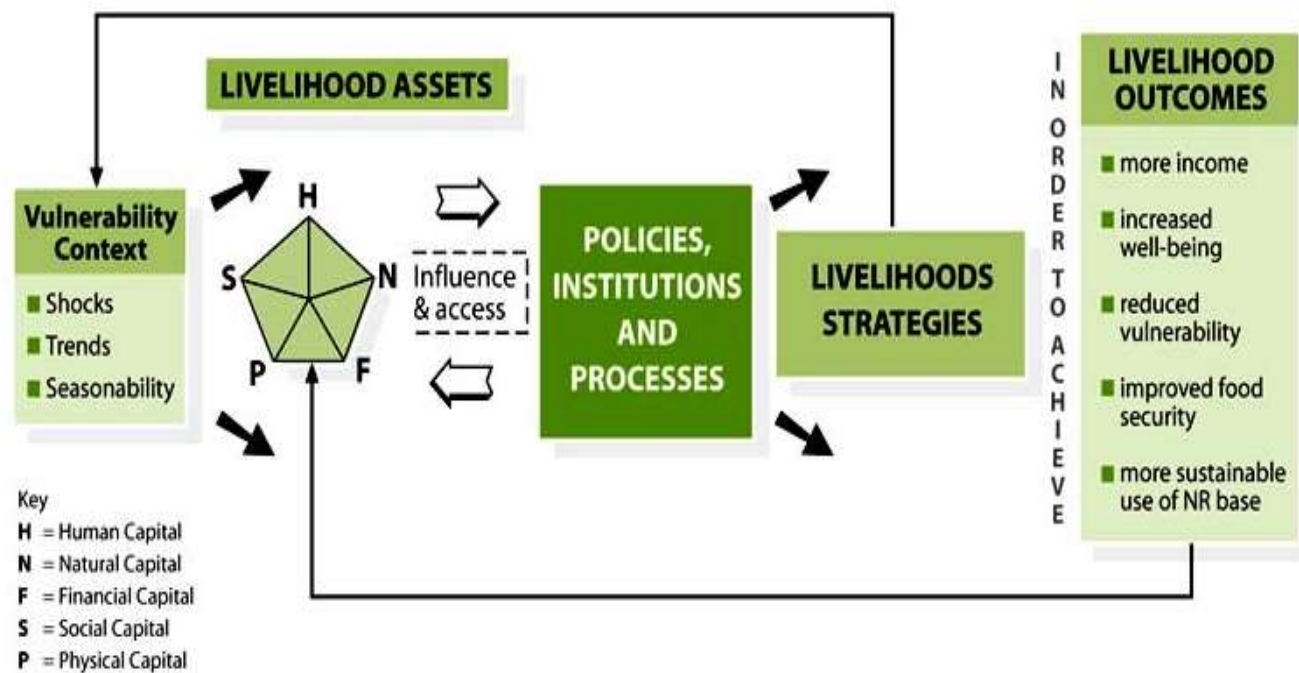
Causes :

- Poverty
- *Demographic dividend*
- COVID-19 & unemployment
- Profit making motive
- Narcotics geopolitics
- Lack of Cross-regional & inter-state cooperation
- Illiteracy
- Climate
- Loose law & order situation

What should be done ?

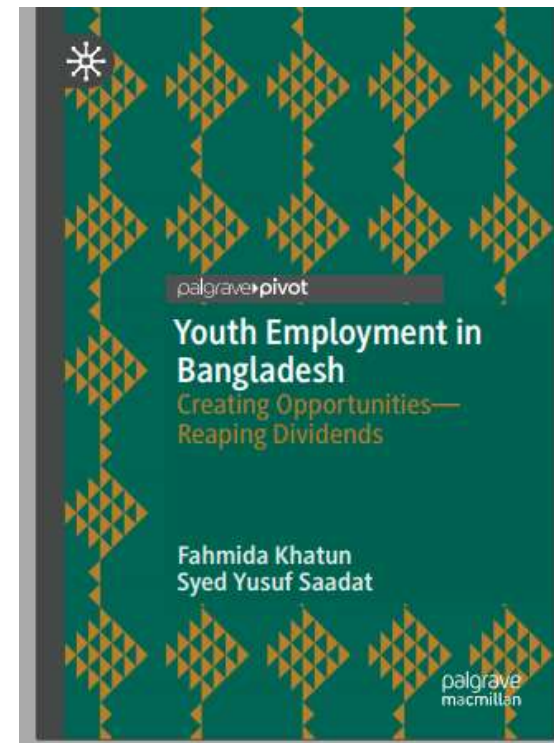
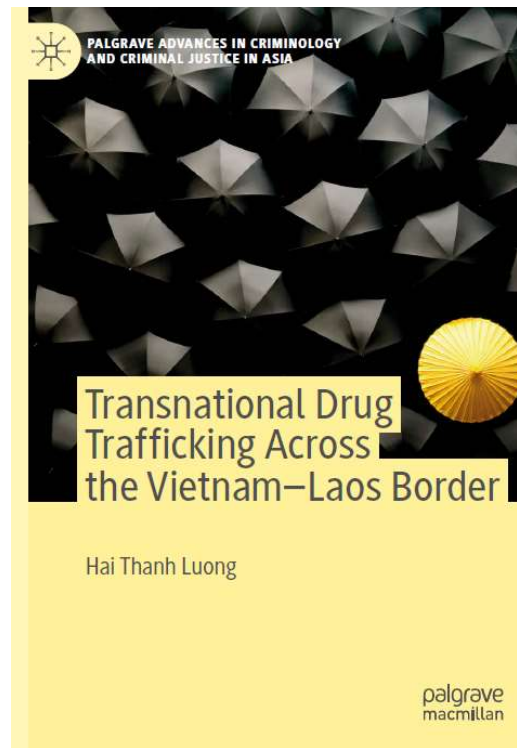
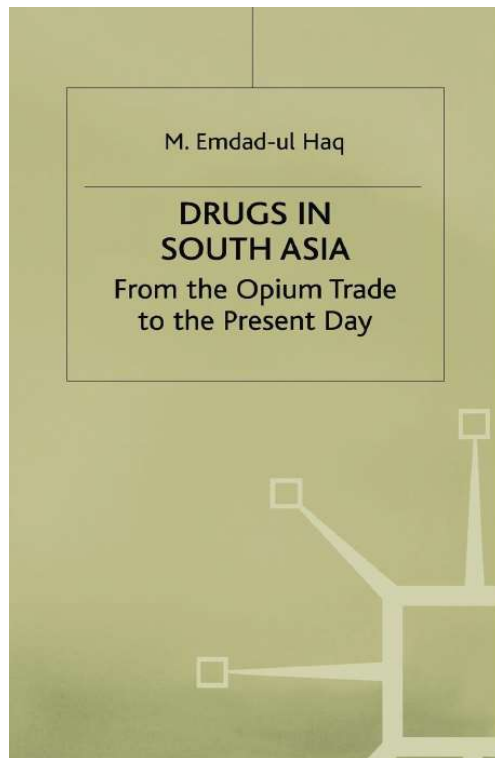
- Demand reduction
- Supply chain disruption
- Rehabilitation
- Solving Rohingya Refugee crisis
- Money laundering control & Punishment
- Border control
- Jobs creation
- Sustainable livelihoods framework (SLF)
- Education & Awareness building programs
- Family bond & values
- Follow UN conventions

Figure 1: Sustainable Livelihoods Analytical Framework



Source DFID

References:





সোমবার, ০৭ ফেব্রুয়ারি ২০২২

সর্বশেষ বিশেষ সংবাদ রাজনীতি করোনাভাইরাস বাংলাদেশ বিশ্ব বাণিজ্য মতামত খে

অপরাধ

মাদক চোরাচালানের তিনটি অঞ্চলের কেন্দ্রে বাংলাদেশ

গোল্ডেন ট্রায়াম্পলের অন্তর্ভুক্ত মিয়ানমার দক্ষিণ-পূর্ব এশিয়ার যে ছয়টি দেশের বাজার সামনে রেখে আইস উৎপাদন করছে, এর মধ্যে বাংলাদেশও রয়েছে।

আহমদুল হাসান ঢাকা

প্রকাশ : ০৫ জানুয়ারি ২০২২, ২০ : ৩৪



43% of unemployed population addicted to drugs

Arifur Rahman Rabbi

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Around 43% of the unemployed population of the country are addicted to drugs.

Dr Arup Ratan Chowdhury, founder President, MANAS, Association for the Prevention of Drug Abuse, said this during a discussion at the Dhaka South City Corporation (DSCC) Nagar Bhaban office on Wednesday.

Home Minister Asaduzzaman Khan Kamal attended the program as chief guest, while DSCC Mayor Sayeed Khokon was a special guest at the program.

Department of Narcotics Control (DNC) Director General, Jamal Uddin Ahmed, and DMP Commissioner Asaduzzaman Mia were at the program, among others.

Dr Arup said: "We have seen several official and unofficial research statistics, which say there are around 7.5 million people addicted to drugs in Bangladesh.

"Among them, 80% are youth, of whom, 50% are involved in various criminal activities."

Of the total, 48% of drug addicts are educated and 40% are uneducated. Around 57% are sex offenders, while 7% are infected by human immunodeficiency virus (HIV)

Among the addicted population, 43% of females take yaba pills. Poor women and street children are engaged in selling and transporting different types of drugs.

Prof Arup said: "Around 1,60,000 drug traders are operating their business across the country. Among them 27,300 are women."